Note: Physicians are responsible for communicating all information, whether positive or negative, regarding a patient's clinical status. While nurses may provide information in accordance with medical orders, this is generally limited to less significant matters. In other words, even if we are aware of the situation, we are not authorized to inform the patient or their family about the diagnosis; that is the responsibility of the physicians.

Case 1: A Disappointed Patient Wishing to Go Home
Situation:
Patient X, aged 51, wants to go home because it is their grandchild's birthday.
However, due to an infection in their leg, they must remain in the hospital for a few more days.
The patient was looking forward to celebrating this special occasion and is deeply upset about being unable to attend. Consequently, they have lost their motivation and no longer wish to get out of bed.
● How would you explain the situation to the patient?
● How would you offer comfort and encouragement, while demonstrating that you understand their disappointment?

Case 1: A Disappointed Patient Wishing to Go Home

Inside the Hospital Room: A bright atmosphere, a single-patient room with a hospital bed. The patient (Tom, 51, appearing somewhat elderly and unhappy) is lying in bed with his back turned, the television is switched off.

Using VR Headsets: The ability to approach the bedside, sit down to make eye contact with the patient, and observe realistic facial expressions.

Patient: "Please, don't keep pushing me. Today is my grandchild's birthday! I've been waiting for this day for months, and I bought a wonderful gift. I'm fed up with just lying in this bed, I have no motivation to do anything. Just let me go home, let me go be with my grandchild!"

Nursing Approaches for Explaining the Situation and Maintaining Clinical Boundaries:

Option A:

"I understand that you want to be there for your grandchild's special day. However, it is essential that you remain here so that the infection in your leg can improve. I will arrange for you to have access to a phone so you can make a video call to your

grandchild today, and I’m sure your spouse can deliver the gift. To ensure you can embrace your grandchild joyfully once you’ve recovered, you need to put in a bit more effort now. Let's get ready for a walk."

Option B:

"Mr. Peterson, I know how much you want to be with your grandchild on her special day. However, we need you to stay in the hospital a little longer so that we can fully bring the infection in your leg under control and conduct the necessary medical tests. To avoid disrupting your recovery process or putting it at risk, it would be safest, both for your own health and that of your family, for you to remain where you are and stay in a sterile environment."

Option C:

"I understand your position. Recovering from an infection takes time. I can speak with the doctor and arrange for you to be discharged for the day."

Option D:

"You cannot leave and interrupt your treatment. Your grandchild’s birthday is not more important than your health. If you want to get better, you must stay in bed and follow our rules."

Case 2: An Angry Family Member
Situation:
The daughter of an elderly patient is angry because she feels her mother has to wait too long for assistance when she needs to use the restroom. She says to the nurse, "You really don't take good care of your patients at all!"
● How would you approach this conversation and respond to her concerns in a professional manner?

Patient's Daughter: (Loudly and angrily) "My mother needs to go to the restroom, but even though she pressed the call button multiple times, no one came! Because of you, she’s been put in a very difficult and stressful situation. I don't think you take good care of your patients. In fact, I don't think you’re doing your job well at all!"

Option A:

"You are absolutely right to be upset. Please accept my apologies on behalf of my colleagues; this was their irresponsibility. I will speak with the doctor and arrange for the nursing staff to be changed."

Option B:

"It truly concerns me that your mother had to wait. I apologize for the delay. Our immediate priority, of course, is to attend to your mother's needs. I will also speak with my colleagues to ensure that a situation like this does not happen again."

Option C:

"You cannot speak to us in such a harsh, scolding manner. There are patients throughout the hospital whose conditions are more urgent than your mother's, we cannot focus solely on you. If you wait your turn patiently, someone will eventually come."

Option D:

"I understand the situation. We are quite busy right now; we'll look into it later. Please go back to your room and wait for us to arrive."

Case 3: A Patient Afraid of a Nurse
Situation:
During a conversation, a patient becomes emotional and eventually states that they no longer wish to be cared for by a specific nurse.
The patient explains that this nurse's direct communication style frightens and unsettles them.
● How would you comfort the patient and reassure them, without judging the other nurse or taking sides?

Patient: (With teary eyes and a trembling voice) "I... I don't want the blonde-haired nurse to come into my room anymore. She speaks so harshly, it upsets me. She even shouts. Every time she walks in, I feel terrified and stressed."

Option A:

"Don't dwell on things like this, it will pass. Just take your prescribed medication, get some rest and focus on getting better."

Option B:

"Don't you worry at all, that blonde-haired nurse is rude and behaves poorly toward everyone. I've noticed it too. I'll make sure a formal complaint report is filed against her."

Option C:

"The blonde-haired nurse is someone who does her job very diligently, I think you might be overreacting. Please try to focus on your recovery instead of being so sensitive. Unfortunately patients don't get to choose their nurses, whoever is on duty at that time is responsible for your care."

Option D:

"I'm glad you shared this with me. It is our duty to ensure a safe and comfortable environment for you here. While it's true that our staff members have different communication styles, we certainly don't want this to affect you negatively. I will speak with the nurse, without creating any conflict, to explain the situation and arrange for a different nurse to attend to you."

Case 4: A Patient with a Poor Prognosis
Situation:
A patient's condition is deteriorating significantly. According to the physician, the prognosis (the expected course of the illness) is poor. A family member asks the nurse: "He's going to get better, right? We really want to take him home."
● How can you offer comfort and support to the family without making promises about the patient's prognosis or jumping to premature conclusions?

Patient's Wife: (With tear-filled eyes and a tone of desperation) "It seems like my spouse's condition is getting worse every day. Please, tell me the truth. He's going to get better, isn't he? We want to be able to take him home, safe and sound..."

Option A:

"The situation is clear enough, there's no need to upset yourself by asking again. Unfortunately, it appears there is nothing more that can be done medically."

Option B:

"We are doing everything we can, but the rest is up to the patient. Just try to stay positive, time will tell what the outcome will be."

Option C:

"I completely understand that you want to see your spouse recover and return to good health. Everyone here is working toward the patient's well-being. Our doctor will be able to provide more specific information regarding his health, though the situation may remain uncertain. Please try not to distress yourself further until you have received a detailed update."

Option D:

"Don’t worry, try to keep your spirits up. We have seen patients get through stages like this before. He will recover and regain his health, that is certainly what we all hope for."

Case 5: A Patient Exhibiting Verbal Aggression While Demanding to Go Home
Situation:
A patient is displaying verbal aggression because he wants to go home. He accuses the nursing staff of doing nothing and does not understand why he needs to remain in the hospital. Blood tests have indicated a potential new HIV infection (*de novo* HIV). Further testing is required to confirm the diagnosis and discuss an appropriate treatment plan.
● How would you prevent the patient’s verbal aggression from escalating by maintaining a calm, professional, and empathetic demeanor?

Patient: (In an aggressive, shouting tone) "Who do you think you are, keeping me here against my will! You’ve been drawing my blood for days, and that’s all you’ve done! Don’t try to stall me with these tests, I want to be discharged right now! If I’m going to die, just tell me!"

Option A:

"You cannot say that we aren't doing anything, sir. Whether or not to begin treatment is, of course, your decision. We cannot accept responsibility. If you leave, you will be putting your own health at risk."

Option B:

"Please, stop shouting. There is a suspicion of HIV in your blood, your situation is quite serious! Your condition is infectious. If you leave now, you will be putting both your own life and the lives of many others at risk."

Option C:

"Please, sit back down calmly. You can leave once the tests are finished, there’s no need to make such a big deal out of this. If you have any specific questions, I can have the doctor come to speak with you."

Option D: (Maintaining a certain distance, in a calm tone of voice)

"I understand your insistence on going home and the tension you’re feeling due to the uncertainty. However, shouting only disturbs our other patients. Certain areas that require further monitoring have been identified in your blood test results. We need to conduct additional tests to ensure we can continue your treatment in the best possible way. Once the results are in, our doctor will share them with you. Please, allow us to do our job."